

MICHAEL D. BENNETT, PE

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SUMMARY

Civil engineering PhD student with geotechnical focus. Experienced in inspecting subsurface exploration, performing calculations and running software for design, writing technical reports, and monitoring construction. Strong technical and general communication abilities. Polished interpersonal skills.

QUALIFICATIONS

- Perform monitoring of geotechnical drilling and foundation and earthwork construction.
- Prepare geotechnical designs using a variety of technical standards and software programs.
- Write reports for clients summarizing design recommendations and daily field oversight.

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Virginia Tech **Blacksburg, VA** **Aug. 2025 – Present**
Research Assistant

Working with Prof. Alba Yerro to model deformation behavior of subgrade soils beneath temporary roadway mats used for military operations and disaster relief efforts. Have completed all qualifying exams.

GFT (f/k/a Gannett Fleming) **Audubon, PA** **Apr. 2024 – Jul. 2025**
Project Engineer (Geotechnical)

Assisted in leading and completing designs for geotechnical work for infrastructure projects.

- Prepared preliminary geotechnical studies and structure foundation reports.
- Reviewed and evaluated commercial geotechnical reports on behalf of municipal clients.
- Inspected installation of auger cast-in-place piles to ensure compliance with plans and specifications.

American Geotech. and Envi. Services **King of Prussia, PA** **Aug. 2021 – Apr. 2024**
Project Geotechnical Engineer (from Aug. 2023); Geotech. Specialist (prior)

Completed geotechnical exploration and design for transportation infrastructure projects.

- Prepared subsurface exploration programs for projects. Used findings to order lab testing on specimens, prepare foundation design recommendations, and write geotechnical reports.
- Processed data from site investigations to create subsurface profiles of engineering properties.
- Used computer models and relevant codes to design suitable foundations for subsurface conditions.
- Wrote, reviewed, and revised reports for issuance to PennDOT and PA Turnpike on behalf of clients.

Gilmore & Associates **New Britain, PA** **Jun. 2020 – Jul. 2021**
Civil (Geotechnical) Designer

Performed geotechnical site exploration, design, and construction inspection on public and private projects.

- Reviewed and performed designs of retaining walls for municipalities and developers.
- Analyzed expected performances of embankments and foundations in Settle3 and Slide2 programs.
- Inspected field installation of driven pile and drilled shaft foundation elements.
- Created diagrams in AutoCAD and gINT programs for geotechnical reports.

Langan Eng. and Envi. Services **Philadelphia, PA** **Aug. 2019 – Apr. 2020**
Staff Engineer

Contributed to all stages of geotechnical design and construction on private projects.

- Obtained and classified soil borings and rock cores from project sites.
- Ensured compliance of earthwork and foundation construction with design specifications.
- Summarized field findings and observations in daily reports for project managers and clients.

EDUCATION

Virginia Polytechnic Institute and State University Blacksburg, VA
PhD student, Civil Engineering, geotechnical concentration
M.S., Civil Engineering, geotechnical concentration

GPA: 3.90/4.00
Planned: May 2029
Jul. 2019

Lafayette College

Easton, PA

B.S., Civil Engineering, *summa cum laude*
B.A., History, *summa cum laude*

May 2017
May 2017

PUBLICATIONS (Last 5 years)

- Whelan, M., A.R. Sheth, M.D. Bennett, T.J. Brennan, and J. Hogan. 2027. "Construction adjacent to critical infrastructure: Clear Well Basin construction at Philadelphia's Baxter Water Treatment Plant." In *Proc., ASCE 2027. Philadelphia, PA: ASCE*.
- Bennett, M.D., and A. Yerro. 2027. "Modeling subgrade deformation from vehicular loading over temporary roadway mats." In *Proc., ASCE 2027. Philadelphia, PA: ASCE*.
- Bennett, M.D. 2026. "Dale Dike Dam (UK, 1864)." *Association of State Dam Safety Officials*.
- Bennett, M.D. 2026. "St. Francis Dam (California, 1928)." *Association of State Dam Safety Officials*. <https://damfailures.org/case-study/st-francis-dam-california-1928>
- Schueller, A., M. Gardner, M. D. Bennett, W. Zhan, J. Shawler, and N. Stark. 2026. "Surveying the aftermath: Post-storm geotechnical insights into barrier island breaching during Hurricanes Helene and Milton in southern Florida." *GeoStrata*, Apr./May: 34-41.
- Whelan, M., A.R. Sheth, M.D. Bennett, and T.J. Brennan. 2026. "Application of auger cast-in-place (ACIP) piles in urban infrastructure: A case study of Philadelphia's Samuel S. Baxter Water Treatment Plant." *Deep Foundations*, Jan./Feb.: 49-55.
- Bennett, M.D. 2025-26. "Our roots: Terzaghi's principles of soil mechanics." 8-part series in *GeoStrata* magazine to commemorate centennial of geotechnical profession.
- Whelan, M., A.R. Sheth, M.D. Bennett, and T.J. Brennan. 2025. "Application of auger cast-in-place (ACIP) piles in urban infrastructure: A case study of Philadelphia's Samuel S. Baxter Water Treatment Plant." 50th Ann. Conf. *Deep Foundations*, Hawthorne, NJ.
- Bennett, M.D. 2025. "Abu Mansour & Al-Bilad Dams (Libya, 2023)." *Association of State Dam Safety Officials*. <https://damfailures.org/case-study/abu-mansour-al-bilad-dams-libya-2023>
- Bennett, M.D. 2025. "Carsington Dam (United Kingdom, 1984)." *Association of State Dam Safety Officials*. <https://damfailures.org/case-study/carsington-dam-united-kingdom-1984>
- Bennett, M.D. 2025. "Building Ruth's house: The geotechnics behind 1923's Yankee Stadium." *GeoStrata*, 29 (2): 64-70.
- Bennett, M.D. 2024. "The death of a dam: The South Fork Dam breach." *USSD Dams & Levees*, 199 (Winter), 38-42.
- Bennett, M.D. 2024. "Reexamining the dam and geotechnical engineering aspects of the 1889 South Fork Dam breach and Johnstown Flood." *Association of State Dam Safety Officials*. <https://damfailures.org/case-study/south-fork-dam-pennsylvania-1889/>
- *Magazine profile*: Beauregard, M.S., and J.G. Collin. 2024. "New Faces in G-I: Michael D. Bennett, P.E., M.ASCE." *GeoStrata*, 28 (2): 64-65.
- Bennett, M.D., and T.J. Kennedy. 2023. "Exploring the historical development of geotechnical engineering." *Deep Foundations*, Jan./Feb.: 87-90.
- Bennett, M.D., and T.J. Kennedy. 2022. "A study of aspects of the historical development of geotechnical engineering." 47th Ann. Conf. *Deep Foundations*. Hawthorne, NJ: DFI.

PRESENTATIONS (Last 5 years)

- "The more things change: Core tenets of Lafayette engineering's success over 200 years." *Lafayette College Engineering Division: College Bicentennial Commemoration* (Sept. 2026, Easton, PA).
- "Lessons learned from the St. Francis Dam breach." *Dam Safety, ASDSO* (Sept. 2026, Raleigh, NC).

- “Diffuse-Double-0-7 (a James Bond parody).” ASCE Geo-Institute (Jul. 2026, radio play). Wrote and co-starred.
- “A misunderstood disaster: The Frank Slide of 1903.” Assn. of Geohazard Profs. (Jun. 2026, webinar).
- “Scouring the archives: Bridge pier geotechnology in the Roaring Twenties on the B&O and Virginian Railroads.” ASCE Virginia Section – Roanoke Branch (Jun. 2026, webinar).
- “The Mohrx Brothers (a Marx Brothers parody).” ASCE Geo-Institute (Nov. 2025, YouTube). Wrote and co-starred. <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=imiZUkCnoP0>
- “Application of auger cast-in-place (ACIP) piles in urban infrastructure: A case study of Philadelphia’s Samuel S. Baxter Water Treatment Plant.” 50th Ann. Conf. Deep Foundations, DFI (Oct. 2025, Nashville, TN). Co-presented with Abhijit Sheth, P.E.
- “Lessons learned from the Carsington Dam failure.” Dam Safety, ASDSO (Sept. 2025, Cleveland, OH).
- “Death in the canyon: Geo-aspects of the 1928 St. Francis Dam breach.” ASCE Geo-Institute (Aug. 2025, webinar/YouTube). <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=j2skPGk0S-Q>
- “Geo-Legends, Season 5, Episode 3: Ralph Peck.” ASCE Geo-Institute (Jun. 2025, YouTube). Discussion panelist. <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gU-jLLuauVQ>
- “A bridge for Phoebe Snow: The Tunkhannock Viaduct’s geotechnical history.” ASCE Lehigh Valley Section (May 2025, Fogelsville, PA).
- “The South Fork Dam breach and Johnstown Flood of 1889: A civil and dam engineering history of the USA’s deadliest dam failure.” Assn. of State Dam Safety Officials (May 2025, webinar), Pittsburgh Geo-Institute (Feb. 2025, Carnegie, PA), Virginia Tech graduate geotechnical program (Nov. 2023, Blacksburg, VA), and Delaware Valley Geo-Institute (Jan. 2023, King of Prussia, PA).
- “The Three StooGeos (a Three Stooges parody).” ASCE Geo-Institute (Apr. 2025, YouTube). Wrote and co-starred. <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Fb09Aa9gGD8>
- “Geo-history: How we’ll benefit from a stronger foundation.” Geotechnical Frontiers, GMA/ATA/ASCE Geo-Institute (Mar. 2025, Louisville, KY). <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tCyAiM0m9Jg>
- “Building Ruth’s house: The geotechnical history of the 1923 and 2009 Yankee Stadiums.” Metropolitan [NYC] Geo-Institute (Feb. 2025, webinar).
- *Video interview*: Bryant, J. “Leadership Lessons Learned from Digging into the Past: Michael Bennett.” Engineer Your Success (Feb. 2025, YouTube). <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=JQnY6ZWumKg>
- “A monument and its meaning: the Lincoln Memorial’s geotechnical and civic history.” Geo-Institute National Capital Section (Dec. 2024, webinar).
- *Video interview*: Keelor, B. “Director’s Cut, Season 5, Episode 21: Michael Bennett.” ASCE Geo-Institute (May 2024, YouTube). https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8N3upComt_w
- *Video segments*: “Interviews with the Industry” – 4 geo-history segments. Deep Foundations Institute (Apr. – Sept. 2024, YouTube). Video 1: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1x60-Gc3U8w&t=642s>
- “A study of aspects of the historical development of geotechnical engineering.” 47th Annual Conference on Deep Foundations (Oct. 2022, National Harbor, MD).

PROFESSIONAL CERTIFICATIONS & MEMBERSHIPS

- Professional Engineer, New Jersey (No. 24GE06042200) and Pennsylvania (No. PE094741).
- Sept. 2022 – present: Certified Drilling Inspector, Pennsylvania Department of Transportation.
- Aug. 2023 – Jul. 2025: Webmaster/Board of Directors, Delaware Valley Geo-Institute.
- Memberships: ASCE Geo-Institute, ASDSO (Dam Failures and Incidents Committee), DFI (Women in Deep Foundations Committee), USSD.

SELECT ADDITIONAL SKILLS

Computer: LS-DYNA, Slide2, Settle3, LPILE. **Language:** Basic proficiency in Spanish.

Other: Author of *Geotechnical History* blog for ASCE Geo-Institute, 2021-present. Eagle Scout.